items to be cached for longer than 24 hours, while Chrome, Opera, and Safari cache items for a maximum of five minutes. If the Access-Control-Max-Age header isn't specified, Firefox doesn't cache the preflight, while Chrome, Opera, and Safari cache the preflight for five seconds.

> **NOTE** The preceding browser-specific numbers were pulled from looking at the browser's source code, and this behavior may change in the future. It's not clear how Internet Explorer's preflight cache behaves, because it isn't documented and Internet Explorer's code is not open source.

4.7 Summary

This chapter introduced the concept of a CORS preflight request:

- The browser sends a preflight request to ask the server for permission to make the actual request.
- The preflight request protects servers from receiving unexpected requests.
- The preflight request asks permissions to make requests with certain HTTP methods and/or add custom HTTP headers to the request.
- The preflight request takes the form of an HTTP `OPTIONS` method with an Origin and Access-Control-Request-Method header.
- The server can grant permissions to use certain HTTP methods by using the Access-Control-Allow-Methods header. The server can also grant permission to use certain HTTP headers by using the Access-Control-Allow-Headers header.
- The preflight result cache is a performance optimization that helps reduce the number of preflight requests made to a particular endpoint.

The previous chapter and this one introduced you to the headers to handle most types of CORS requests. But there are still some features, such as cookie support, that are not covered by the headers in this chapter. Chapter 5 takes a look at how to support these remaining features on CORS requests.